



Learn English with Friends

The One After the Superbowl

Vocabulary & Comprehension Lesson

Intermediate/Advanced Reading Module



The Biggest Broadcast in Sitcom History

In 1996, this episode aired directly after the American Super Bowl. With 52.9 million viewers, it remains the most-watched episode in the show's history.

Lead-out

(noun): A TV program scheduled immediately after a major sporting event to capture a massive audience.

Ross & The Hollywood Monkey

Ross discovers his old pet monkey, Marcel, didn't die. Instead, the zoo secretly sold him, and Marcel is now working as a famous animal actor in New York!

Vocabulary

Cover-up (noun): A planned attempt to hide a mistake or crime. (The zoo worker admits the monkey's death was "all a big cover up.")

Showbiz (noun): An informal word for the entertainment industry.





Joey & The Dangerous Fan

Joey receives fan mail from a woman named Erika. He is excited until he realizes she cannot tell the difference between Joey and the fictional doctor he plays on TV.

Vocabulary

Stalker (noun): A person who obsessively follows or watches someone.

Delusion (noun): A strong belief in something that is completely false.

Joey's Reality

- I am an actor.
- I play a doctor on TV.
- Erika is an obsessive fan.

Erika's Delusion

- He is Dr. Drake Ramoray.
- We are in a real hospital.
- I am dating a neurosurgeon.

The Result = Misunderstanding
(noun: a failure to understand something correctly).

Joey & The Dangerous Fan

Joey receives fan mail from a woman named Erika. He is excited until he realizes she cannot tell the difference between Joey and the fictional doctor he plays on TV.

Vocabulary

Misunderstanding (noun):

A failure to understand something correctly.

(Erika's delusion leads to a serious misunderstanding of who Joey really is.)



Phoebe's Musical Truths

Phoebe is hired to sing songs to children at the library. However, her songs contain harsh truths about death and life, which completely shocks the parents.

Brutally honest (adjective phrase): Telling the truth in a direct way that might hurt or shock someone.

Inappropriate (adjective): Not suitable or proper for a specific situation or audience.



Chandler's Dinner Disaster

Chandler meets his former 4th-grade classmate, Susie. He doesn't realize she is still angry about a joke he played on her as a child, and she is planning to steal his clothes.

Prank (noun): A practical joke or mischievous act.
Revenge (noun): Action taken in return for an injury or offense.



Monica, Rachel & The Movie Star

The best friends meet an action movie star. Their friendship is tested when they both try to date him, leading to a hilarious physical fight.

Escalate (verb): To become more intense, serious, or aggressive very quickly.

To drop the ball (idiom): To make a mistake or mishandle a situation.

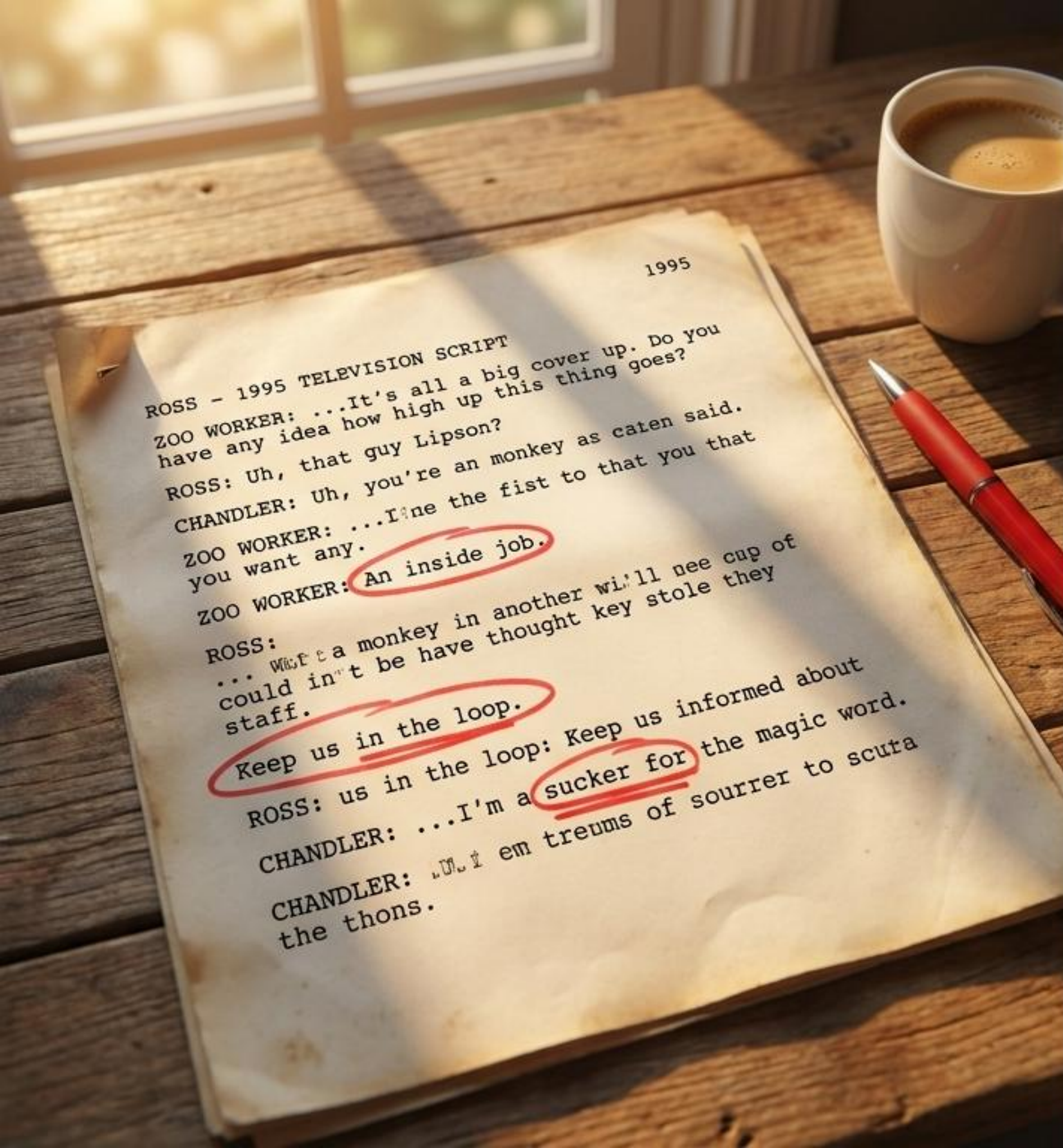


The Guest Star Matrix

Character	Guest	Theme	Vocab
Ross	The Zookeeper	Mystery	Cover-up
Joey	The Stalker	Obsession	Delusion
Chandler	Susie	Payback	Revenge
Monica & Rachel	The Action Star	Rivalry	Escalate

Real Phrases from the Script

- "An inside job": A crime committed by someone working for the targeted organization. (The zoo worker says the monkey was stolen by staff).
- "Keep us in the loop": Keep us informed about what is happening.
- "Sucker for [something]": To easily fall for or be convinced by something. (Chandler says he's a "sucker for the magic word").



Comprehension Check: True or False?



Statement 1: The zoo told Ross that his monkey was alive and working in Hollywood. (T / F)

Statement 2: Erika completely understands that Joey is just an actor on a television show. (T / F)

Statement 3: Susie steals Chandler's clothes to get revenge for a childhood prank. (T / F)



Vocabulary Practice

**Fill in the blanks using:
Inappropriate, Escalate, Delusion**

Question 1: Erika suffered from a _____, believing Joey was a real hospital doctor.

Question 2: The parents thought Phoebe's honest songs were _____ for young children.

Question 3: The argument between Monica and Rachel began to _____ quickly.

Short Answer Challenge

**Answer the following questions
in 1-2 complete sentences.**

Question 1: Why did Susie want to go on a date with Chandler in the first place?

Question 2: Why were the parents at the library upset with Phoebe's performance?



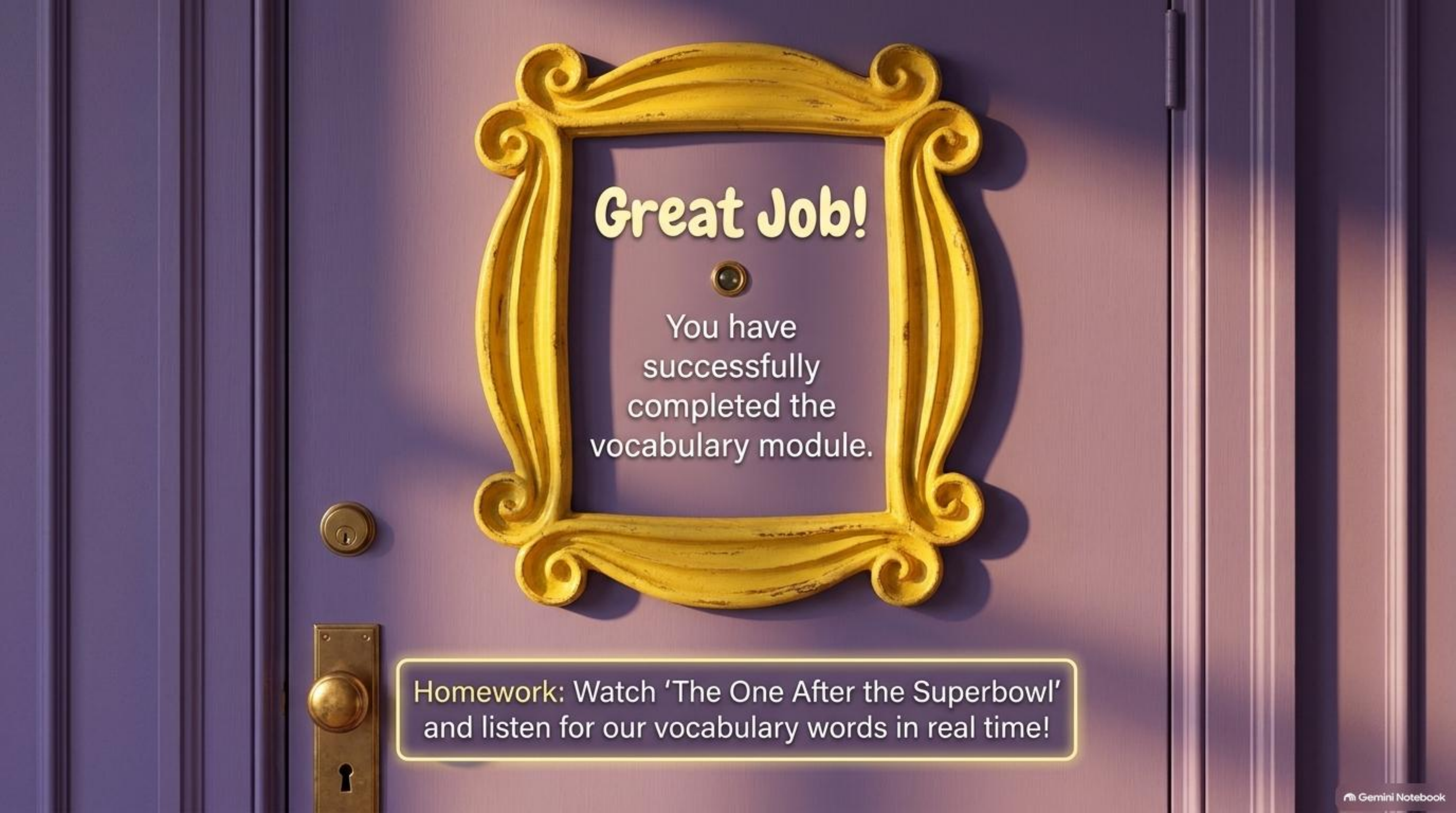


Speak Like a Friend!

Discussion Prompt 1: Have you ever experienced a funny misunderstanding? What happened?

Discussion Prompt 2: Has a small argument ever escalated with a friend?

Action: Use the vocabulary from today's lesson to tell your partner a story!

A blue door with a gold frame containing a congratulatory message. The frame is ornate with scrollwork. The text inside the frame reads "Great Job!" in a large, bold, yellow font, followed by "You have successfully completed the vocabulary module." in a smaller, white font. Below the frame, there is a gold doorknob and a keyhole. In the bottom right corner, there is a small logo for "Gemini Notebook".

Great Job!

You have
successfully
completed the
vocabulary module.

Homework: Watch 'The One After the Superbowl'
and listen for our vocabulary words in real time!